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Beeville, Texas
September 14 1945

To The Citizens Committee
West Side School
Beeville, Texas

Dear Sirs:

This is to express the appreciation of the Beeville Public School Board for the cooperation and continued assistance which your committee is giving the Board in its efforts to build a creditable public school system that will adequately serve all the scholastic population of our little city. We believe with you that education is the solution to most of the social and economic problems that confront us as a part of a Democratic Nation and are doing our best to see that every scholastic child in Beeville has equal opportunity to receive that needed education.

As American citizens we all accept the theory that education is the foundation of a Democratic institution and is therefore a function of our government.. In Texas our forefathers wisely laid the foundation for a public school system of which we can justly be proud. In Beeville your Board of Education accepts the responsibility placed upon us by the state and by the citizenship of Beeville Independent School District of seeing that every dollar that comes into the school treasury is used to the best possible advantage in giving every boy and girl an equal opportunity to receive this education.

Your School Board fully appreciates the fact that it or any other small body of citizens alone can not build an adequate school system. It is an undertaking that deserves and requires the cooperation and best efforts of every parent and public minded citizen of Beeville. We are happy that your committee, representing a large section of our citizenship, accept this responsibility and pledge your best efforts in helping us to solve the problems that arise in our efforts to improve Beeville Public Schools and make Beeville a better place in which to live and enjoy life.

With regard to some of the specific problems confronting the West Side School, as mentioned in your communication, the Board wishes to express its appreciation for your efforts in calling these matters to its attention and to pledge our best efforts in finding a solution for them and other problems that may arise. Most of these problems will likely be administrative and should be taken up with Mr. Tanner and through him with Mr. Cates both of whom you may be assured will be glad to cooperate with you to the fullest extent. Your continued effort in educating the parents to their responsibility in building a better school and enlisting them in the work is appreciated. We again wish to assure you that we shall be glad to hear any problem that you feel should be called to the attention of the Board and to have any suggestion that you wish to present.

With further reference to the maintaining of a separate school for the children of Latin American decent as you will recall it is the expressed desire of the Board to bring all the schools together in so far as it is consistent with good teaching practices and our conditions and equipment will permit. We are happy that it was possible this year to move the 7th and 8th grades to the East Side School.

The Board fully agrees with you that more attention should be given to music among your children who are natural lovers of this fine art. The moving of these two grades to the East Side places the 7th and 8th grades in position to take advantage of regular band music. As was expressed in the conference an effort is being made to place some elementary music in the other West Side grades.

The matter of greater use of the English language among your children is a problem incumbent equally on the school and on the parents. Greater emphasis will be placed on the use of English on the school ground. But unless, through parent - teacher association and other of your organizations you are able to encourage the more extensive use of English in the homes this will likely continue to be a serious school problem.

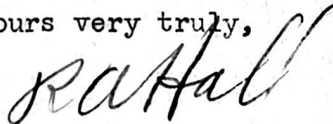
The matter of school attendance is another problem equally incumbent upon school and parent. A proper checking of daily attendance can be established by the principal and teachers but without the full cooperation of all parents it can not be successfully worked. A better solution of this problem apparently can be worked out with Mr. Tanner.

Because of very inadequate attendance laws your Board does not feel that a turant officer would be a solution to the problem. Such an officer probably would impose hardships on some while the real offenders would not be reached. The matter of recess time interference by individuals not in school seems to be a problem of a little closer cooperation with local law enforcement officers. This we feel sure can be accomplished through the efforts of your committee and the school authorities.

The difficulty which is apparent in the beginner grades of the West Side School by the number of pupils that are retained in the first grade each year we believe is due to our teaching system. Six year children intering school unable to speak English should not be expected to learn English and do the normal first grade work in one year. Apparently the solution to the problem is adding a primary grade for the beginner who can not speak English. Time would not permit this change for the present session. It is being worked on and we hope will be ready for instilation at the next school session.

Again expressing an appreciation for your efforts in assisting in building a better school system and soliciting your continued support, I am

Yours very truly,



R. A. Hall,
Chairman of the Beeville Public School Board

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